

MIRA RDF Documentation

Simple guide for the MIRA SPARQL endpoint

Purpose. This document gives a concise description of the MIRA RDF data exposed through the MIRA SPARQL endpoint. It follows the simple structure: entity types first, then the Wikidata properties used in the RDF.

Modelling note. MIRA entities use stable MIRA URIs, while relationships and descriptive statements use Wikidata direct properties where appropriate. The manuscript modelling follows the Wikidata WikiProject Manuscripts approach, especially the use of instance of (P31) manuscript (Q87167) for manuscript entities.

1. Entity Types

The MIRA RDF dataset currently represents four main entity types: library, manuscript, person, and text.

Entity type	MIRA URI pattern	Description	Count	Wikidata alignment
Library	https://mira.ie/entity/library/{id}	Represents holding institutions or repositories associated with manuscripts.	71	Typed as library (Q7075)
Manuscript	https://mira.ie/entity/manuscript/{id}	Represents individual manuscript catalogue records.	300	Typed as manuscript (Q87167), following the Wikidata Manuscripts data model.
Person	https://mira.ie/entity/person/{id}	Represents people associated with manuscripts or texts, such as authors, scribes, translators, or editors.	10	Typed as human (Q5).
Text	https://mira.ie/entity/text/{id}	Represents textual works contained in or associated with manuscripts.	7	Typed as literary work (Q7725634). The URI uses text, not work.

2. Wikidata Properties Used

The RDF uses Wikidata direct properties in the wdt: namespace. The following table lists the Wikidata properties currently used in the MIRA RDF output.

Property	Wikidata label	MIRA usage	Note/example
P31	instance of	Defines the type of entity, e.g. manuscript, library, person, or text.	Manuscript entities use P31 → Q87167 (manuscript).
P217	inventory number	Records the manuscript shelfmark or catalogue identifier.	Example: Cod. 86b/1.
P195	collection	Links a manuscript to its holding library or repository entity.	In MIRA RDF this usually points to a local MIRA library URI.
P1071	location of creation	Records the place of origin/creation of a manuscript.	Values point to Wikidata place QIDs where available.
P571	inception	Records manuscript dating.	For ranges, both start and end years are included where distinct, e.g. 0840 and 0849.

			Where the start and end year are identical, RDF stores one P571 value.
P2048	height	Records manuscript height.	Values are expressed in centimetres in the current RDF.
P2049	width	Records manuscript width.	Values are expressed in centimetres in the current RDF.
P953	full work available at URL	Links to an online manuscript resource or related digital copy.	Used when a URL is available.
P1574	exemplar of	Links a manuscript to a text entity.	The MIRA URI uses /entity/text/, not /entity/work/.

3. Additional RDF/SKOS/OWL Terms Used

The dataset also uses a small number of non-Wikidata RDF terms for labels and cross-links.

Term	Usage
rdfs:label	Human-readable label for an entity.
skos:prefLabel	Preferred label for display and browsing.
owl:sameAs	Links a MIRA local entity to an equivalent external Wikidata item where available.

4. Example Manuscript Record

A typical manuscript record looks like this:

```
<https://mira.ie/entity/manuscript/1>
  rdfs:label "Archiv des Benediktinerstifts – Cod. 86b/1" ;
  skos:prefLabel "Archiv des Benediktinerstifts – Cod. 86b/1" ;
  wdt:P31 wd:Q87167 ;
  wdt:P217 "Cod. 86b/1" ;
  wdt:P195 <https://mira.ie/entity/library/st-paul> ;
  wdt:P1071 wd:Q142 ;
  wdt:P2048 22.5 ;
  wdt:P2049 15.5 ;
  wdt:P571 "0840"^^xsd:gYear,
          "0849"^^xsd:gYear .
```

This means: the MIRA entity is a manuscript; it has the shelfmark Cod. 86b/1; it is linked to its holding library; it has a place of creation; it has height and width values; and it includes both start and end years for the dating range.

5. Output Structure

The converter outputs one combined RDF file and separate RDF files for each entity type:

```
mira_wikidata_aligned.ttl
entities/
  library/
  manuscript/
  person/
  text/
```

6. References

Wikidata WikiProject Manuscripts Data Model:

https://www.wikidata.org/wiki/Wikidata:WikiProject_Manuscripts/Data_Model

Wikidata property P31 (instance of): <https://www.wikidata.org/wiki/Property:P31>

MiRA SPARQL endpoint: <https://mira-sparql.universityofgalway.ie/>